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advancements that have been pioneered by homeland security and law enforcement departments. Hence, the lead, with respect to product development and its technology, still rests with the West. However, once we get close to these high-level accurate algorithms as well as the financial investments that are required for R&D in this domain, we could be self-sufficient in manufacturing and delivering end-to-end biometric solutions for different applications," states Mohsin Syed, vice president, sales and marketing, BioMoRF Systems. Launched by Infronics Group, BioMoRF is an innovative combination of three robust technologies – biometrics, mobile technology and radio frequency.

With imports on the rise, countries like China and Taiwan are dumping products without any set specifications and standards. This, too, hampers the growth of manufacturing within the country. Players prefer to import and sell cheap and low-quality products rather than take the trouble to manufacture them. The government should set some standards for these products so that unorganised players and the grey market can be curbed. "We have not come across any product made in India yet in this segment. The biggest obstacle is that most components would need to be imported and Indian customs' rules make it extremely difficult to import components, thus making supply chain availability extremely unpredictable," says Oh Tee Lee.

Echoing the same view, Sanjeev Sehgal says, "The manufacturing industry in India can only grow if there are some major benefits for locally manufactured products, which could be in the form of customs duty relief or tax benefits. India should develop a strong raw material and components base, too. The government has to come forward with a specific policy to encourage investments in this sector. A comprehensive package of incentives is required to attract investments in



*Thermal network camera from Axis
Communications India*

this sector so that the industry becomes viable and lucrative."

Manufacturing also requires huge investments in terms of acquiring machinery, space, manpower, resources (raw material) and design capabilities. However, technological advances are more in software-based solutions than in hardware. "Manufacturing companies source about 70 per cent of the components from other countries. The real fact is that sometimes complete dependence on imports can lead to logistical problems that might affect manufacturing schedules," explains Srikanth Pisapati. Players therefore prefer to import the devices and integrate them into complete solutions.

The future

With the demand for security devices and solutions rising by the day, there is tremendous business potential for all players in this segment. "There is ample opportunity for R&D houses that develop innovative technologies; for manufacturers that launch high-quality products; and distributors,